Full timestamped transcript

Intro to the Sales Process and Prospecting

Brianna Salinas | 500 Eurasia Batch 11 | Recording: 28 September 2026

Automatic transcript - use the audio for exact wording

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Full recording: 02:10:50 | **Main lecture:** begins around 00:25

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[00:00:28 - 00:00:32]
Is anyone else alive?

[00:01:21 - 00:02:07]
She said she shared the food. What is the body yesterday? Ah, what is the body yesterday? Yeah, I was doing something. We were doing it way too hard. Very nice. Okay, we're still missing a few people, but we need to get started. So let's finish that coffee. You guys ready? Yes. So who are we missing? Who's the wall? Boogie. Medi-Mine. Boogie. Medi-Mine. Boogie. Okay. Great. Thank you so much for being here on time.

[00:02:08 - 00:02:54]
I hope you had a good rest of a Sunday. That you rested or bored. This week I will be here only today and tomorrow. Again, apologies, this is unusual. I usually am here for the full two weeks, but now we're working on launching two new funds and I have to travel more. This said, I am very much aware of what's going on, even when I'm not here, and I want to talk a little bit about that. We shared with you the dashboard. There's two sides to the dashboard. There's a dashboard that we use to track

[00:02:54 - 00:03:42]
the assignments that we would like you to work on during these first two weeks, at least to get started. There's a which we mark with red yellow green as in done done, not done, we're in progress. There's a dashboard where we track the key KPIs for each of the companies. I understand this latter one is still working progress for some of the companies, but it's very important that by the end of this week, everyone knows what are their North Star metrics or their KPIs that they're working towards in the next two months when you're working remotely. On the first part, which is the assignments for last week and this week, I will share it later.

[00:03:43 - 00:04:30]
The situation is pretty grim right now, there's a lot of people with work undone or even not started. the mentors will come to you to understand why that is, but we definitely need to work on that. So I'll show it now actually because I have another thing to cover. So this is what I'm saying. So at this point, if you look at these two first weeks, this is just to get started. we look at the first one, you know, there's a lot of people there that not started stuff or are in progress. If the in progress means that it's being discussed with the mentors and it will be soon finished, okay? But if it's in progress as in to say, I had a dream

[00:04:30 - 00:05:19]
of all it last night, therefore I started with a task, that doesn't count, okay? So again, we're, we're, I don't want to have to be looking over your shoulder, neither does the staff or the mentors and this is not this is not elementary school but we know from past experience that if you go home for week three without having these things completed the two months of experimentation that you're going to do remotely will be going to waste because you go home and then instead of like immediately starting to use our our capital in the one you raised for growth experiments you're going to still be trying to figure out who am I selling to and where are the channels that's the type of shit that needs to be

[00:05:19 - 00:06:10]
defined here it's easier to discuss it in person with us while you're here so please make like a real honest effort to get this stuff done for these first two weeks so that when you go here you're going all in on growing your companies. I started saying this a while ago but I'm repeating it more frequently here in the conferences I go to in the meetings I have for investors. You guys in all the other batches before we used to pitch your the opportunity as in in CEE, Caucasus, Central Asia, Baltics, we have super deep tech talents and all we need to do is we need to show the world that this deep tech talent can make good products.

[00:06:10 - 00:06:58]
The challenge is that in the last two years, with everyone being able to build anything at any point, very quickly with AI, this advantage that you guys used to have because you were very good deep tech talent teams is vanishing very quickly. And the competition is definitely becoming on GTM, on sales, on distribution. This is very very important because if you don't put this in your own minds and you keep telling yourselves we're amazing technologically, our tech stack is better than anyone else, fuck these Silicon Valley guys because we're better, it doesn't matter if you're better. You would have to be a hundred times better than your US competitor for everyone else

[00:06:58 - 00:07:41]
in the world to care about you. So please make sure that you get the foundational stuff done these two weeks so that in the next two months we go all in on these distribution metrics that we want. Because we want you to come to week 11, week 12 and go on stage and have impressive growth charts or impressive logos that you signed up like impressive metrics. But you won't get there if you Any questions or comments about this? We are struggling a bit right now with pedigree, it's always in the morning.

[00:07:45 - 00:08:32]
The more time we spend on making sure we can, as soon as possible, and also modifies or integrate the tasks so we can leverage those three months and we are working on these things for sure we make good progress but it's taking away from that specific goal right now for us which is making sure we can launch a model right so that's why I think for us is we are making these things like a million programs but this is never like a step to versus making sure I can launch this and then you can go in all and all the distribution. I'll answer your question. Thank you. You're thinking about things as two different possibilities. That's why you're saying that there's nothing wrong.

[00:08:33 - 00:09:22]
But my challenge to you is that they are complementary. For example, you want to build this thing, you want to launch, but where we come in right now, by the way, guys, there's only one week left. all the time you spend here if not i think i told you in the last batches you will only join this accelerator like the ones in your life you probably joined another accelerator but this one is probably the ones i'm asking raising it that way invest let's put that into context if i'm you i'll think about this question while i'm here in the next four days five days only five days that i try to hit this target i try to build this what is it that i can download or get a different perspective You see the difference in how you can get that. You're still doing, but you're also

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absorbing it in a new perspective and also you're trying to figure out different ways how to help you launch faster or to get to the results faster. So when you think about it from purely implementation point of view, it seems like this is something that's happening. But if you think a little bit longer, this is actually accelerating. Right? Yes. And all I'm trying to do is we go to the ask, we get all capital allocation, yeah obviously why time is so important especially how the world is developing class time is to balance out the best way possible to make sure we don't just learn everything and then I tell you the

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but victor victor sorry let me interrupt you so we can use the time wisely you have three minutes left you have to put things in perspective it took you a long time to get to where you are two weeks if it was two weeks because it's five days but if it was two weeks of delaying to go live i would prefer to delay the go live two weeks and leave here with all the toolkits that you need that when you go live you just execute rather than only getting half of the value because you're here, half time in presence but then the other half time you're still thinking about the launch and then none of these two things will be well done. So I'm using you as an example but it applies to everyone else.

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Delaying whatever you have to do for another week is not going to kill your company. it's better for you just kill it and that's it before i buy the money anyways let's let's let's let's forget about this now um we're gonna i need i need to start i need another 10 minutes or so okay uh first week uh first week has passed what was i want to go company by company What was the one thing that significantly changed for you or your company?

[00:11:31 - 00:12:14]
Let me reword that. What was the one thing that you significantly changed in your company because of things you've heard on week one? One thing. You can take a minute or two to think about it. I need 10 minutes. I was thinking about the metric clarity for the team. What are you doing here today? It's just a little bit. Metric clarity for the team. So we used to have different things to care about. We really got very detailed on what we tried and why in order to move the team to get the honest business.

[00:12:16 - 00:13:02]
Metric clarity for the team. Clarity for the team. In roles, responsibilities, organization? Yeah, basically engineering and also to do operations, all in all what we have to do and why. And everyone is aligned and everyone is responsible, everyone is possible. Yeah, this is actually a super important point because often times as we start growing the companies, I felt this when I was doing my companies, some people are not super motivated to do their things faster because they don't understand the impact that those things have on the company's success, especially for development. Why the fact am I doing this line of code? Why am I doing the landing page this way? Because I don't love it, I'd rather do it that way. So it's very important at this stage when the teams are very small

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to make sure that everyone understands their direct contribution to the bottom line or to the top line or to whatever is your KPI. For us I think we went back and challenged a few assumptions we had from the beginning and we understood, look, experiment more into even your fundamentals, your pricing, your landing page and base your decision on the data you get from these factors. We haven't done this in various aspects. we have done this for some but not some of the core aspects for the region. Okay, very important. It's exactly what we want especially with week one but also week two is to question all your assumptions even if it's just to confirm that they were right.

[00:13:51 - 00:14:41]
I agree. Sorry Julie. Not to be metrics. For us it was very important to realize that we need to live very quickly to meet clients and we are in active stage of pilots now. And we got the framework of success plan before onboarding and commitment on success metrics with the client before we even sign. And this will allow us to manage expectations for those sites. And we were not even thinking about it. Can you say it differently? I didn't understand. We were jumping on signing the contracts with clients without thinking on how to deliver value from our platform quickly. And we always had cases where we were onboarding clients, but not in a client scale.

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When do we meet them? What will they receive from us? At which point? And I feel now like we have control of what we're going to do with them. Otherwise we will just, with scanning, go to the cows. Okay, so contracting versus onboarding, timing it better and making sure that you know what you need to deliver. So you have the opposite challenge of most people you were selling first and figuring it out later. Okay, good problem to have. Yes? For me it was because many times we like know what we should do or how things work, but we really not write those flows, the marketing flows and the company flows,

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how the customer comes from B to point Z. Also, it really can help you see the gaps and what we need to work on. So for me this was like maybe one of the biggest things to really write the flow down, marketing flow, funnels, so we really see on paper, not just think about these things. So for me this was like really like eye open and smooth head. Documenting things is definitely very very important especially for those of you who are doing this almost alone. We may have other people like on your side, right? I think we very much, with Justina, I think I wanted to validate that our approach is correct at the beginning of where we are actually going right now.

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Yes, we have the agents and everything, but where we go right now, I think we have the experts at our team a lot more, and I feel a lot more confidence that what we are doing right now has the value. there are a lot of problems associated with our customers, which even for the problem stuff I kind of knew here in my mind, writing them down so clearly, because now that's a lot of really understanding between one and one of our consumers. And I think the biggest, biggest thing was that yes, this direction is in a direction for a short time. We are agreeing that the most important method for us is retention, hard time, conversion

[00:17:05 - 00:17:49]
from pilots to customers and it will show us that we are closer to our work and moreover we clarify that like let's say predictive metrics that can show us that we really deliver the value for our actual clients and it's very important because our goal is to go to the stage and show that look like this is our clients, customers after the pilot and because they are growing. This is everyone. I see everyone typing on their laptops.

[00:17:50 - 00:18:38]
It's because I'm feeling at being a good speaker. It's my fault, not your fault. But I'll try to get better and be more exciting. This point that Dimitri made is very important. These days in AI, one of the things that investors are looking at is is pilot to client conversion. this sounds obvious, everyone wanted conversion from pilot to paid, but the thing is now with AI there's so much more pilots and it's so much easier to start pilots that pilots are no longer a relevant metric or very very almost not relevant. It's this conversion that you mentioned that is very important. So as much as you can do you need to stay on top of who's doing the pilot, how are

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because you did better onboarding and you know what they expect about the pilot and you are on a daily basis or weekly basis depending on how long the pilot is checking in on that even if you just like a quick call hey how's it going are you getting it are you not so in you've heard you know you know, or if you haven't you should have heard, Paul Brands saying that you know do things that don't scale until you can scale. This is the type of things that you have to do at the pilot level to make sure that you will get paid by it. sometimes it's better to have fewer pilots listen to this it's better sometimes have fewer pilots now of high quality with lots of hand holding to

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make sure that you have a high conversion rate from pilots to pay then having a hundred pilots and then only one percent of us Got it? Thank you for not typing while I say that. Okay, who am I missing? My point is to say about pilots, so I make sure it is a bunch of white pilots and a person. So this is my grandmother. Okay.

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And another thing is how it's going to be positioned in the environment. This is also important for me. I have presented water and how I am not saying this to the world and the pilot will be too to work in two years, I mean, if it had a real estate, I would assure that there is a good deliverance for the house. Okay, thank you. I can't agree with all the things that you just mentioned, but maybe one thing, actually it's a bit deeper, that we have an approach of being rest of the best and, you know, disrupting the industry and so on. and actually it does not need trust, so it's just scary for our customers it seems to be

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and I think we do not need to be smarter than our customers, just serving them properly and this will give us and it changed a lot of things like it gives us a better focus that while we are doing something, can we are doing something else? because we think that's a good idea because we can justify it based on customer feedback that that's how we can pay them for one dollar. Yes so if someone related with some of the things we already said about you know treating pilots properly treating the onboarding properly so you know what they're expecting therefore you're delivering to them in the short term. I want to add one more thing here and then we can get back up for today.

[00:21:39 - 00:22:22]
Or for now, or for a week. Everything you said this morning, a lot of what I said this morning may make you believe that everything you should do now is a lot of hand holding, a lot of making sure the clients get what they want and that is true, but there is a time limit to that. So at one point you do have to start doing things that don't scale to do things that scale. Learning or finding out where you do that is as much an art as it is a science and it's something that you can do with us.

[00:22:25 - 00:23:14]
But if you think about your fundraising timeline, and I'll pledge time today and we'll talk about this again. If you think about your fundraising milestones, from now until your next race, for most of you, it will definitely matter that you did these things that don't scale and you have a high conversion to pay and you have clients that are giving you high ratings or referring you to others or they're allowing you to put your logos on your sales materials it's more important than having you know 50% growth rate week on week especially if that 50% growth rate week on week is not reflected in revenue just use your growth but not revenue

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right so let's continue working on this making sure that between now and your next fundraising milestone you have in that fundraising milestone or deadline I mean the things that you need at that time in at lunchtime I will talk about what are the things that you need at that time okay 10 minutes I want to give you time. 10 seconds. Pedro said, Matrix needs something done this week. I want to square you the way we do today. So in office hours, if you guys want to vote me, whatever, describe me. Five minutes, we make a decision and go. So I want to square you the way today. Everybody know.

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I know we've done it myself, but come again. We are out there. Thank you. Thank you, everyone.

[00:24:20 - 00:25:06]
Okay. I'm just going to ask you guys to not be on your computer. So all we're chatting is 90 minutes and they give me our undivided attention for 90 minutes. So if you can do that, that would be lovely if you need to call or do something. Go outside, it's going to be distracting and it will be distracting. And I'll probably just scare you and put it right back on that. Yeah? Okay. So for this week, I'm going to tell you about what we're doing this week. So we have aligned expectations around what we're going to do for each session. So today we're going to do an overview. And the reason that I want to do an overview first is because I want to make sure we're talking about the same thing and we're aligned in talking about what the buying process looks like, what creating ICPs looks like, and what value propositions for customers look like.

[00:25:06 - 00:25:53]
And the value propositions will be the most important thing you do today. You have your value proposition, hopefully. Are you done? I want to let you see them. You have yours, everyone? Yes? OK. So today we're going to do customer

value propositions. And the customer value propositions that you do today, you're going to use tomorrow. You're going to use at the end of the week. On Thursday and Friday, when you do sales demos, you're going to use them every time you talk to customers. You're going to use them for the rest of your work. that you're providing to customers instead of your futures. If you take away one thing from this week, I hope they take away that you stop talking about futures and you stop talking about value. So today, we're going to do an overview. We're going to do customer value propositions and ICPs. And so we'll leave with that from the day today. Tomorrow, we have two sessions.

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We do outbound in the morning. So we talk about messaging, using our value propositions from today. And in the afternoon, we do discovery calls. So what's your discovery calls, scripts, and all of those It's usually different than what you guys have been doing if you do a workshop in the afternoon. We have two separate ones split so don't skip the afternoon because it's a very different session. Yes? On Thursday we're going to do sales demos. So I'll have a talk about how to run a sales demo, how to do it, like how to interact with your customers. And then on Friday you guys will be doing a mini version of your sales demo to the group. They'll have 10 minutes, 7 to 10 minutes. Yes? An actual demo, like a customer. I'll be your customer. Just tell me who I am, right? And then you'll present it. Ultimately, if you are not B2B, I know some of you are doing B2C here doing things, like the same funnel, the same flow, every value that I talk about, you will do for investors.

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You can do the investor flow, right? Doesn't matter to me if you want to do that instead, or you want to do both of them and you want feedback on both, great. Also, you all know I talk a little fast. If you need me to slow down and repeat something, just like way to be interactive, yes. Also stop me through the questions, be interactive. I know you'll love listening to me for 90 minutes, but like I would like this to be interactive and have you guys chat and not just listen to this on the byways. Yes? Perfect. Okay, great. And we have team members that we wanted to join for the sales session online. Anyone have anyone they invited? Hopefully maybe Kato? Yes, I want to speak. Okay. You know the sales session in sales demo? Sorry? What do you mean sales session? Oh, for right now. Just the session we're doing now. Like if there's anyone else on your team, the salesperson or someone else that's not here that you would like to attend the session.

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just have them join virtually. It's recorded if you want, but I know Kato wants to attend. So if anyone wants to know. Okay, perfect. Perfect, perfect. Okay, so today. Okay, so today we're defining B2B sales and what that means and how to think about it differently. We'll talk about the buyer's journey, right, and thinking about how your customers purchase things because how you sell and how they buy are very different things. And usually people don't think about how people buy and they're thinking with other customers they're just thinking about their next steps um icp and customer value propositions and we'll also talk about stakeholders um and again whether you're selling to a business where you whether you're partnering with someone right or if you're doing partnerships you're going to do the same process um and you'll talk about value the same way um okay so first we're going

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to talk about defining b2b sales just so we're on the same on the same page right when we're talking about b2b sales we're talking about usually selling to an organization with multiple stakeholders right you'll have a couple stakeholders sometimes there's one very rarely there's one there's way often more than one right there might be six there might be 20 there might be 50 there's a lot of stakeholders involved right and so we're thinking about that and thinking about how we manage all those relationships and how we move those forward even if you don't talk to all the stakeholders right they're talking internally without you right and so you need to think about how you're part of conversations that they're having. You have a little longer sales cycle, right? And we'll talk about transactional versus a complex sale and the difference between those and thinking about where you fall on that. A demo during the sales cycle, right? Usually it could be a B2B sale. You have

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some sort of demo, whether it's a created demo or you end up doing a demo with the customer. Tads for larger deals. Something that often happens because people want to see what it looks like first. Or you need to do a lot of setup and pre-work and so you want them to commit to something you do all of the setup for them for a shorter time. You must track conversion metrics to be successful. So we'll go over a little bit today, but we'll have a separate session where we talk about the sales funnel and what you should be tracking in your CRM to make sure that you're tracking all the things that you should be tracking to make sure that you hold yourself or the other salespeople accountable. Yep. And

then sales are based on solving a business problem, right? They're not based on features. They're not based on how cool your product is. They're not based on like how good your website is and how innovative and fine your technology is.

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It's always based on a problem. Business is fine to solve a problem and you should always be speaking to the problem solved. Always, always, right? Um, when we're thinking about

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our funnel and what it looks like you're going to see this a million times with me because we're going to talk about different stages in different places has everyone seen like a funnel like this before ish a little bit okay so on our left we have like what our outbound um what our outbound looks like right so you have like identify your markets you're building your icp you're identifying your stakeholders you're finding contacts you're doing a bunch of research, prospecting, right, and you qualify your leads and it turns into a sales qualified lead, which we'll talk about more tomorrow because you'll be doing this on your discovery calls, right, into down-level negotiation one. And on the right, you have your marketing funnel, right, and so you should be tracking these separately, and again, we'll talk about tracking your funnel metrics in another session, but having your outbound and having your inbound, which is your marketing.

[00:30:46 - 00:31:34]
So marketing is also bringing leads in to the same channel. you have your marketing qualified leads and then your sales qualify them and then they go on the funnel yes no questions okay fantastic okay some common sales mistakes i like to go over these at the beginning because someone said everyone makes um everyone is our customer everyone could use our product our product is so good that everyone could use it yes i'm sure they definitely can however right not everyone is your best customer right now right you spread your resources too thin you spread your team too thin, you don't message to the right people if you're trying to target everyone at once. So we really want to focus our ICPs. I talked with some of you last week about really targeting our ICPs and being very, very specific about them. I'll talk about ICPs in a little bit more about how to do that, but I really want you to focus and narrow in on a very, very narrow market

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to make sure that you're speaking the right language to the right people and solving the problem they have. Another one, hiring sales reps too early, right? Also very common. Founders are like, oh, I'm going to this new market. I'm going to go to E-box, I'm going to hire E-box rep, and they're just going to sell a little degree. That very, very rarely works out, right? If you don't know the market, if you don't know the space, if you don't know the messaging, if you don't know the problems that they're solving, it's unrealistic to bring in someone else to do the same, right? And so when you're hiring sales people, you're setting them up, you have to have done it first, right? to be successful, to be able to show them what to do or how to align expectations on what to do next. Building before selling, right? This is a more common with technical patterns. When you're like, I'm going to tell them the same piece, tell them the same way thing and everyone's going to love it.

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And then there's definitely a user product because we built this really cool thing, right? Making sure that actually the market that you're going after, that you're solving a problem before, wants the thing before you build it. That a couple people want it before you build it, yeah. And then competing on price. It's really easy. What if I just give them 20% off? I'm going to talk to them and then they'll buy it because they're cheaper than the other one. We don't want to be a product that's a race to the bottom. If you raise to the bottom, then the other person, who might have more money, either fundraise more or they're just a bigger company, they're like, well, we'll go 30% off. And then you're both racing to the bottom to just compete on price. We don't want to compete just on price. So you want to compete on that. You want to compete on the value that you're bringing to people. Right? And sometimes it can be something as easy as like, we have a phenomenal onboarding.

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Right? We send someone to your office. We have someone that goes through with your team, sets it up, sends everything up, walks you through it. Because sometimes larger companies are starting to raise a bunch of money. Just give people a product and they're like, be free. See how it goes. And it's really hard for the customer to onboard. They're like, onboarding is terrible. We actually never used it. We paid for it for a year and we didn't use it. Right? didn't have a good onboarding so sometimes something as simple as a better more structured onboarding can win you a customer over someone else yes so thinking about that um when we are thinking about the different types of sales and thinking about where you are who's seen like who thinks they're a transactional sale has anyone thought at all like which type of sale you are because that's complex yeah more okay

[00:33:55 - 00:34:41]
Okay, who feels like they fall more over here on Transactional? Okay, who feels like they fall more complex? Okay, who thinks they're going to help? You have both. Yeah, you have both. Okay, right, when it's transactional you have like one decision maker, one or two decision makers, a low contract value, and it depends on your region in terms of like what the contract value is, right? Like in the Bay Area, you're pretty transactional if you're under a 2K a month. You're pretty much a transactional sale, right? If you're over that anymore, then you're usually more of a complex sale. There's more stakeholders involved. But in different areas, right, that might be different. It might be $200 a month, $50, wherever you're going, thinking about how you're selling to the customers and thinking about the stakeholders that you have.

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Your complex sale, if you're selling to a government, if you're selling to an enterprise, if you're selling to anyone with a logo that other people recognize, complex right um usually people end up having a couple different sales cycles that you're tracking in your phone right so you're having your more transactional ones which maybe if you're selling smbs mid-market accounts right you have your funnel set up because you know that they're going to close within 30 days um you have to talk to one or two people you know what the process is like you have a couple meetings and they're closing versus your complex one you're like this might take six to nine months to close right we have to meet with 15 people we have to have these stakeholder meetings to have this like review deck we have to have almost like a business review of what we're doing what we're doing next we have to have proposed plan for business outcomes and we have to get

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exactly design right that would be a more complex sale so when you're thinking about like where you are on the process that you have when you have multiple people doing sales on your team also thinking about who is best for each one right maybe someone who's really good at transactional sales right when you're hiring a salesperson when you're interviewing and thinking about who um usually people's experience or background fall in one or two. They're more transactional rep and they're used to high turnover deals like going very quickly or they're on the enterprise larger deal side and they're used to multiple stakeholders like longer deal cycles and process. And you want to make sure that you hire the one that fits. That fits you, not just like a salesperson who's good at selling. You want to find someone who's sold in the same way that your product is sold now.

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To allow them where you are. Any questions? I'm really kind of fine so far. Just soaking it in. So if you want me to climb in. Okay. Okay. Let's start the buying process. Okay. So typical buying process. Let's talk about what the buying process looks like traditionally when they're thinking about buying something, right? At the very, very beginning, they need to learn that they have a problem, right? They need to understand that there's a problem that they need to solve. If they don't understand there's a problem they need to solve, then they need to learn that they have a problem to solve, right? If you're trying to sell to someone who doesn't think they have a problem, that's going to take you a really long time to close them. Because you not only have to teach them about your product, you have to teach them that they have the problem that your product solves, right? So when you're talking to anyone, any potential customer, I want you to think about where they're at and what they know.

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Right? So they'll learn. And then after they say, OK, I do have this problem. I have a problem. I need to solve it. Now I need to figure out what I actually need to solve this problem, right? And that usually involves talking to other people within the team, right? Making a list of like priorities of things they need to do, even if it's in their head, right? Maybe it's not written down, it's just in their head like, okay, we have this problem with our team. What do we need to have to solve it, right? And then they go out and they explore. And they're like, who would solve this problem for me? I have this problem. I know kind of what I need. Now I'm going to go talk to a bunch of people to find it out, right? So when you're talking to people, are you talking to them when they're exploring options, right? Are they talking to multiple competitors of yours? Did they happen to see you and they're like, oh, I actually think we have this problem, but you're the first one we're talking to?

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Are they still trying to understand their needs? So like, oh, we feel like we need a Sierra. Like most of you right now are probably like, you shouldn't have a Sierra, I'm gonna move off the spreadsheets. And you're like, what Sierra should we use? Right? You're like figuring out what you need, what fits, what fits up at this moment, right? And your

customers are thinking the same. For different things, right? They're evaluating options, right? everything right let's look at the prices and the functionality features let's look at like what people say about them reviews online let's see what the ongoing looks like let's see how long people stay with them right they won't understand like okay let's evaluate what this substance is like they make an internal case right especially if you're a more complex bill they usually don't have the budget that they can just sign off on right if it's under 2k right 2k a month like

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Usually people can sign off on it, if you're talking about a higher person. Like a director or a VC can sign off on that. But higher than that, they have to make an internal case to see this is what we're going to get from it. Here's how it solves the problem we have. And this is what I'd like to do. And sometimes you're involved in those, and sometimes you're not. Sometimes those happen without you. You should try to be involved in them, but sometimes it happens without you. And then it goes through the finance team. And the finance guys are the ones who are always like, And then sometimes they'll come back and say, can we get a discount on something on this? Like our like-minded guy doesn't like this. Right? Our CFO is like, can you get something else? Because that's their job. Your job is to push back. Like, can you go back? Especially at larger corporations, right?

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That's what they like to do. In most of the cases, they ask for them without WTO finance. Yes. Yeah. They ask for? What's done without WTO? Oh, yeah. Yeah. Some of them also, but the finance team will also do a lot because they're just like, we should ask a little bit more. Okay, great. Perfect. And then they confirm, like, okay, we're confirming, we're going to do this thing, we're paying this much, we're paying 50k for this amount, going to order to get this value, signed off agreed, and then you finally get the payment, right? Like stimulus or the pulse? That was my supposed day. Like sign off, yeah, because also often, right, like if it's something that's more expensive, if you have a more complex sale and it's a larger ticket item, the person that you're talking to might not be the one that signs it. It might be someone else that signs it that you don't talk to, right? And so it goes to them

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to sign. Depending on who you're talking to, right, and where you are, or like where you are on the stage, if you're more transactional still, like, it's probably the person that you're talking to, right? If it's more complex now, and you're selling something that's like 50, 100K, like, probably it's someone else that's going to sign it, right, that's going to like sign off on it and agree to it. So then it still goes to someone else outside of the direct person that you're talking to. And so depending on where you're at, right, or who's the one who's pushing it. We'll talk about stakeholders a little bit later to identify where in the buying process each person is or who you're talking to in the buying process. Right? So in the buying during process, there's all these things that happen, right? We're here, we're like, oh, I have a problem, right? We're like, oh, they need to identify, no, they have a problem. And then when they're understanding their needs, they're like, what is important to me? What's important to my business? What do we need

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to have? What's the next to have? Right? What are some things we need to think about? Did we buy something already and it went terribly and we spent a bunch of money and don't actually Did we try to solve this problem internally already and we couldn't build it and it never got off? We spent three months building this and it was not successful. What are the things that they're thinking about when they're trying to understand their needs? Because it's never like, here's this magical problem that just dropped and now we need to solve it. It's like other things have happened for them within the business, within the company that you should understand to set yourself up to be most successful. So many things happen when they're trying to understand their needs and when they're exploring options. especially in a more complex sale, get involved. And I'm like, no, I heard bad things about that company.

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Or I saw these people at a conference and I want to talk to them. Or I have a friend that works over here, so we should try this one, right? Or I saw this thing online, I went to this webinar. Like, there's a lot of voices that are being heard, right? That are talking about like when they're understanding these different people might be different than those different companies. It might not be the same person, right? And when you're going through and you're thinking about like, who are all the people that are involved in this decision? one person and you have to understand what's happening internally, right, before you give them a demo. Absolutely before demo. I'm so curious, like bigger companies, when they look at some type of solution in the market, do they actually fight internally? We should build this ourselves versus we should

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go to this company. Is that like an internal crash that doesn't happen by them companies? There's like a build versus buy, right? your discovery call and we'll talk about discovery call tomorrow and like how to identify some of those. Like you're identifying, have you used something before, right? Did it go well or not well? Probably not well because you're talking to me, right? If they didn't use something before, did they try to build it internally? Are they deciding between building it themselves or buying externally? Because you need to figure out like where you fall. If you're competing with an internal build, right, that's a different discussion because then you're like, okay, If you have two engineers building this and a PM, you're probably spending half a million dollars to build it. Plus you have to maintain it yourself. So then your competition, right? You're like, I know you want to spend half a million dollars to build this.

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You could build it, but we already built it for you. And it's like 10K a month, right? Which is significantly cheaper than you building and managing internally. But that's a different discussion than if you're like, we know we want to buy something internally. And we're evaluating all the options. We want to see if there's something that's a good fit. talking to three of you at once, we're going to run three pilots and see which one's the better outcome. Which you also want to know because you want to know who you're competing against, who they're comparing against, because you don't just want to run a blind pilot. And you're like, great, go for two weeks, for a month, and hopefully you like it. Hopefully it's good, let us know if you have problems. No. You want to know how they're judging you, right? If you don't know, then it's just like you're just crossing your fingers, hoping at the end of the day they like you more than others, right? Then you're not being consultative throughout and helping them understand and decide, right?

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more consultative and you want to be good with them to help them think about and decide what the best decision

would be. Right? Good question. But yes, that happens all the time. Fireballs. When they're evaluating options, right, and they're debating like who is there, there's a lot of politics that happens internally, right? When people are thinking about what should next or what they like or who has the budget or whose budget it's coming from and things that you might not know but you can ask some questions around right to try to find out like what's happening internally like who's owning the budget who's owning the outcome right what the success looks like and who gets that success when it happens right and sometimes when you're competing with people it might be that someone's already like i already like these other guys because they're my friends but we have to evaluate other options so you're evaluating them but you might not know that they already really like this

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other company more that that also happens all the time right um or people are trying to keep the business they have but they're already working with someone but they're like we want to explore their options and see what else is there if you don't ask you don't know that they've tried something or currently working with someone you don't know you're going to think against them but you also don't know what their interaction was like and what happened within there and so tons of things happen there like internally that you are maybe thinking about maybe not thinking about when you're trying to understand what their writing process looks like right and then times you're purchasing there's some blockers right so some people are like it's not closed one until they send money right because sometimes something happens the CEO might be like no actually we're not gonna buy anything for the rest of this quarter it didn't get signed we're not buying it like we can talk about it if you want

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but we're not buying anything else in Q4 right but we all agree and if you had just done it like last week we could have signed it it would have been fine right because just sometimes like right internal things happen so understanding like the priorities of the company when they're doing things and making sure that you understand as much as possible about the landscapes you don't get long sighted there or the bi-imitating right find the students like actually they already spent their budget you thought it could it doesn't but you have to wait three months right now we didn't ask about this earlier like had no idea sometimes things happen that you can't prepare for but you can do a good job of understanding the landscape and your internal customer's landscape of where they are understanding who cares about what, understanding whose metrics are important to whom within the organization, right? And understanding the relationships within them. Yes? Yes? Who's been thinking about their customer response process?

[00:46:18 - 00:47:03]
A lot of people. Okay. Yeah? Mostly? Good. Do you mostly want most of it? And so when we're thinking about a more complex sale, right? And the reason I put this here is because the other one is like super simple, right? When we're like, oh, there's just some things that could happen that you should think about. There are so many more things that happen, right, on the customer's side that you don't see. Because you meet with them, what, a couple times on a call. Some stakeholders come on the call. But there's so many more things that happen, right? They're like, when they're identifying the problem, right? They're like, okay, we have this problem. If you're selling to a large enterprise or corporation, they have to create a deck, right? They have to create a deck to them. This is a problem that we need to solve, that we're going to solve. And here's our plan to solve the problem. And we think we're going to solve it by the end of the quarter, right?

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Or by somewhere else. They're like, OK. So the executives know that there's problems. So they're thinking about a budget or putting money aside for a moment. And the person is doing online research. They're looking for information. They're downloading white papers. They're maybe attending some webinars. Right? And then they're like, is this a problem? But now I'm reading more things about how this is not a problem, that other people actually have this other problem that's not just a problem. I thought I had. So maybe now I have three problems. instead of one problem, right? And so they're like, are these actually my problems or not my problems, right? And so then they're like, well now I'm overwhelmed because there's 20 companies trying to do the same thing and how do I choose? How do I choose which one is gonna be the one that's a good fit for me? Because all of them approximately say they do the same thing, right? So we're talking about our value propositions

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and how you're different, right? And how you fit differently, like that is so important because when the customer is going in, looking at research, right? You see 20 of the same companies and you're all like, we solve problems in the same way. Like we are your sales AI. And you're like, cool, there's 200 sales agents. How do I pick the sales agents?

Right? How do I choose? What was your question? I know it's individual, but like what's the title of the whole big of a company has this title? By your journey, let's say, about 10 days, 100 plus 20 years or like? Oh, I feel like even less than that. But I feel like once you get to like 30 to 50 people, you start having like, not all of the things, but you start having like competing priorities.

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And people have to allocate their budget to certain things. And you have to prioritize and decide like which problem is the one that you should solve right now. Right? And people, but even at a small company, right? A 10 person company. If I'm like 10 person company, maybe I have like two salespeople. And I'm like, oh, a lot of companies are having companies sales AI agents again. I've been like these virtual AI agents to help with sales. I want to see if we can do it. And then I'm like, OK, let me go look. And then there's so many companies that all say they're like a virtual SDR. How do I choose between who is going to be the best fit for me? And now because there are so many people creating more and more things, if your language isn't differentiated, if you're not talking about how your value proposition is different. right let's say that I'm a let's say I'm a dentist and I go and search them like

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dentist CRM or like dentist AI right like if you don't have that wording if you don't have that content available when I go and search that even if you could do it even if your product could service that if I don't see that this is the CRM for dentists like I'm not gonna I'm not gonna buy the product right and so when we're talking about our ICPs and talking about being very very specific not just so you know but still like you can create that content and messaging to really target each person, right? Because if you say you're a CRM for everyone, right? If I'm a dentist or if I am a

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solo founder or if i'm a team of like 50 right those are all going to be very different messaging right and understand that differently but so there's so many things that happen even think about like the last software you guys bought or things that you looking at how did you decide what to buy this is definitely more transactional sale right somebody posted on x somebody posted on x and you were like okay i trust you i'll buy it no i did like I have three more steps to rewrite by . OK. Did you look at any competitors? Just specifically previous. Any more x-posts if somebody else is talking about it? It's pretty much . It's just . It works.

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Yeah. Yeah, from someone that you trusted. This is like one version decision. So this is a different . Yeah. What if you are like a marketing product, or something where you have more people that are more engaging or involved in it, right? Do you guys talk about it as co-founders? Yeah. And I think the one thing we are missing right now, more and more decisions are delegated to AI. So when I evaluate themselves, I'm just writing a code when I'm trying to solve my specific situation, and I'm just asking what kind of solutions might be. And then my choice is basically among these top three. And I already have a winner among those three who is the best fit into my specific situation.

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So that's the kind of evaluation that is happening right now. You need to be in this evaluation otherwise you might not be able to discuss it. Yeah, so imagine a working company because more people are using AI, but like you guys, I would say, are more early adopters. Like a lot of people, if you're selling to an enterprise or a corporate, depending on the team, not all of them are active. Yeah, users, right? And so you'll have some people that do that, that are like, hey, clock, I should use these two things. And someone else is like, yeah, but I did research and I think that these three other companies will be actually best for us in their life. And right? And then they're like, okay, now we have to evaluate them all. What are we going to evaluate them on? what we should do right and so there's so many things happening like inside right when we talk about stakeholders we'll talk about what each type of

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person cares about as you start thinking about them but there's a lot of things happening internally right inside your company and you don't know their process and how they buy things how they bought other software in the past it's hard for you to navigate right because then you end up with things like that for more information so I sent over that or they ask they want to talk about internally And so I sent them a PDF and now I'm just waiting. And you're just waiting. You're just waiting because there's things happening that you didn't ask about. You're not in the conversation. You don't know what they're evaluating. You don't know what they're looking at. And so if you don't know what they're doing and how you can help them be supportive, it's very, very hard for you to move the deal forward. Then again, you're just crossing your fingers and you're like, hopefully you come back to me. We don't want to be done. We don't want to manage the process.

[00:53:10 - 00:53:54]
OK, so the typical selling process. Very simple again. them, you contact them, they come in, inbound, you have a discovery call, you map the org, you have some stakeholders on the demo, folks will negotiate you onboard them. Pretty simple, right? You're like, here's how we're thinking, here's how we're thinking what our process is. But then we're thinking about them, you're like, hmm, how's our process along with their volume process? Do we align? No, the callers align. Do the work align, right? When we're like, oh, they're like learning, they're understanding their needs, and we're like, let's get on a discovery call. Do you have this problem? What are you doing? Do you have I'm not going to be talking about features. It's really lovely, it's really great. Right, and they're like, we're actually exploring options, okay. We're just, we're just wanna see what's out there. We just wanna see what you guys do.

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We're just like learning, right? And you're like, let's move this over though. Don't you wanna try it? Do you wanna pilot? Right? No, we're no, we're just, we're just looking at it, right? And so I want you to think about like where you are, right? Because of tracking your sales, right? And thinking about your next step. they are and they're next in it. Because if you're pushing for like let's do a demo and they're like I don't know if this isn't my problem yet actually. Then you don't want to push them to a demo. You need to understand and make sure that you are aligning with them and their process of like you have this problem, we can absolutely solve it, let me show you how we solve it. And also

I want to understand what your budget is, what that looks like, what success looks like for you, how you buy software internally, right?

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And we'll talk more about those tomorrow. I'll help you write some questions in the script. We're understanding the buying process, right? Some things, some of you it seems like know a little bit more about your business buying process. Some I think are maybe like kind of learning and thinking about this a little bit more. And the same when you're going, when you're fundraising, right? You want to understand the exact same things. So same funnel, keep in your CRM also, have your investment funnel. What are the pain points, right? What is the level of the organization? You want to know what they care about? You want to know how they make decisions? You want to know what else they've got, right? And so I know you did user interview questions, which is seeing you last week, right? If you don't know how a lot of your companies work internally and what they do, these are good things to ask and understand, right? So you can start mapping out the organization.

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If you're selling into a new industry that you don't know, right? These are things that you should find out, right? MBA intern that's in here that's just like their project is to do an analysis of all these products and put it together in a report because then you're pretty far from getting something sold. Right? Because probably their own project. Right? They're going to go through it all together. They have no buying authority whatsoever. Right? It will be very interesting and they'll ask you a lot of questions and it will take a lot of your time. Right? We're thinking about the buying process. Right? Thinking about how many demo calls you've done with them. Right? Like how many stakeholders are on the demo calls? you have the first line person, then you have the next one, and you have to do another type of demo, and then you may put another one with a technical one with some technical

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team members on it. Keeping track of how you're going through the process for your different market segments is really important. Did they evaluate other companies? What content did they find relevant? Did you have to send a proposal to get approved before the contract, or could you just send the contract over? A lot of transactions you can send an account to go through from you and a proposal. But a lot of large companies want a proposal, right? And they want their lawyers to redline it, they're going to comment on it, they'll do some things before you can get some money. Were there other companies doing a pilot at the same time? Again, a lot of enterprise companies would love to do this. They'll do like five to seven pilots at once, and they'll just compare them all across. And if you don't know, you're just going online. You have a set of current pilots, they're going to pay for a bunch.

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And if you don't know, then you don't know what metrics you're up against. How many people were involved in approving? Who signed the contract and what were the problems they're trying to solve? You should know all of these things during the interview. Tomorrow we'll talk about in the discovery call questions to ask DHM. But you should not be doing a demo if you don't know the answers to all these questions. You should be learning and understanding either in the discovery call or in some customer interviews to understand the space and understand the stakeholders and people that you're talking to. So the best practice is not to do demo after discovery equations. You do the demo separately. And separately. It's easier to do separate. If you're a very, very good salesperson, you can take what you've learned in discovery and kind of custom do a demo for them, like on the fly.

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Or if you've done a bunch and you're like, OK, if it's more transactional and you're like, this is the same industry, the same fit, I can do this demo, and it's the same, then you can do it. But generally, you want to prepare and prep for the demo. someone else on because if a discover call is used with one person what you don't want to also do is get stuck in the trap where you can demo after demo after demo after demo after demo because there's different persons who are like oh this person needs to see it. No this person needs to see it. Let's all just get on the call so I don't have to do 5,000 of these right. And so you always want to do the demo after you understand the process, right? Or else you're, again, you're flying blind, right? Then you're going into the demo and you're like, let me show you a bunch of cool stuff and hopefully you like it. And if you like it, then you'll hopefully you'll probably get it. Right? And that is like you're throwing spaghetti against the wall, right?

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You want to go into your demo saying, I understand your pain points. I understand you as the buyer. I know how your buying process internally is going to work. I know how I can solve this problem for you. for you, what the outcome is

going to be, what that looks like, right? And so then they're like, yes, this is exactly what's our problem. And they're like, fantastic. I also know internally what our next steps are. So we can try our next steps after the demo, right? The demo is not here's much of my cool stuff. The demo is confirming the problem, showing them how to solve it, and then . Yeah, the demo is pretty much the same. It's basically a . I am always having a hard time to explain the value of getting another demo to show the same

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basically because it's even easier for us to get through the demos themselves rather than be showing it through the screen share. The question is what should we do in that situation? Do we really need this kind of demo demo? Do people purchase right after saying that first demo? Most of the time we have only one call and this call is basically a discovery call for me. And then the demo thing, it goes to the demos themselves. We see the report in the Slack channel, through the document, because we have

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an application, the person from the company went through the data. And yeah, so I usually can show either the champion or the stakeholder on the first goal for the discovery goal. So the screen share that looks like you guys go ahead and test it. So your demo, also we'll talk about demos more on Thursday too, but But your demo is not the same as your product demo. You're not showing them all of the functionality and all of the features and things that they can do. It's only showing, this is what you're interested in. If you've seen it already, if anyone hasn't seen it, I'm happy to show you some features and functionality of it. If it's a larger client and you're like, here's how we support enterprises in a different way.

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Here's how this is structured and set up. Here's maybe some things that they have questions on things that they're doing to show them. Maybe part of it is part of the product, part of it is maybe like a slide of like showing like either conversion metrics or things that happen that change. But like your demo is like in general, right? Demo is just showing people what they care about to see to solve the problem that they have. It's not like, here's how you log in, you can log in and all these things. Here's your analytics and here's, no, right? They don't care about analytics yet. They care about solving their problem. The analytics are like this thing they want to see later, right? Or if you know that usually people like you want to know how we connect with this or how we get leads to their sales team. Let me show you how easy it is to get leads to your sales team because that's you don't show them the demo. That's like they turn on the back. And you're like this is what this and that looks like.

[01:01:31 - 01:02:24]
So there's probably things that you could show them or things that they care about or things that they like that are different from just the demo. But you don't have to re-show the whole demo. You should not show the whole demo. No one should be showing the whole demo of their whole product at any demo ever. right? Have you heard the term show up and throw up? Very common phrase because a lot of sales reps come and they come and call them like here's all my things, here's all my features, all this stuff, and who you want to buy? And they talk for like 30 minutes and they're like and we do it to buy now, right? No, we don't need to buy now, right? So that's not what we want to do. But we'll talk more about like what to create a few of your demo on how to show up and what it should look like. But it should be very interactive and it should be like here's what people see success in, here's questions people have, here's what we were asking, here's how we set it up on the back end, here's what this looks like, here's what onboarding looks like, more of the setup things that they were using the product.

[01:02:25 - 01:03:12]
Good question. So it's a question we have been thinking a lot lately. So you are in this demo with a large client and we also do this for big business. In this demo we try to find the brain points. So we try to show them how the thing is over. How much is it on the demo? And how many you find in the product you show the brain point with the right path? And how much is on the sales point? What's the human factor there for the success? Yeah, so sorry, are you asking, like, so you don't have a discovery call? Do you do just only a demo? Yes, you. So you're trying to find out their pain points while you're showing them the demo? You have sent an email. Okay. They have responded, yes, yes, and it's good for the call.

[01:03:12 - 01:04:00]
You go on the call, you show them the project. Okay, so if you don't want to show them the product first, first you have to ask the questions, right? If you do them together, which is okay, you just have to practice so it's very smooth. You just want to ask them the questions to the end of the day before we show them the product. I absolutely want to show you the product, can't wait to show it to you. I know you're really excited to see these things. I want to understand first what you're trying to tell, so I make sure to show you the right things. We have a lot of functionality. I don't want to waste your time before my time, right, going through and showing all the stuff if you don't care about it. So let me understand what you care about first, right? Okay, you can really push back nicely. Because first you're nice. This thing was functionality, and it was like if you can put it at the right time, in the right space, then that really changes the part. It's not that there is this super like, I don't know, this technical guy in front of you.

[01:04:01 - 01:04:47]
Just show the demo to me, buddy. Like what are all these questions for? This thing, I thought it really helps. I have

actually 1,000 features right now. Yeah. But. You're like, what do you want to teach? Yeah. Mm-hmm. Okay. So we're right there. Okay. Mm-hmm. We're going to talk about men. So they need to think that first of all, Hey, here's the agenda for our call. Like, first I'm going to ask a couple of questions to make sure I understand what you're trying to solve, make sure we're aligned, right? And then I'm going to show you the demo based on what you told me. Does that sound good? Great. In this journey, how much of significance has the common factor, the sales in itself? The salesman. In this process, do we need a lot of focus on that?

[01:04:48 - 01:05:32]
Really, it's also a myth in sales. I think in more transactional sales, right, people are usually trying to see if the features fit what they're trying to solve, right? If it solves the problem that they have, and if it's not very expensive, they can buy it and move forward or if they're comparing. What you lose with some of the AI agents or having not a human is that the things that you would think about as a person, which takes practice, but the things you think about as a person when you're like, are you piloting other ones? And the way that you ask it, because you can ask things in a softer way, which is not pushy, What is your budget?

[01:05:33 - 01:06:18]
So like, oh, the alligators that side can make sure this already. Are you already spending money on this? Right? The things that you ask in like a softer human way often give you more answers, right? Then if you have something like an AI agent or something else, right? And so that part is very important for a more complex scale because there's all these intricacies and things that you understand that you're like, if you tell me this thing, I know this means x, right? But if you don't have that or you're missing that, And it's not that the salesperson is the best at selling. The best salespeople are the ones that ask to understand, right? That are consultative. That are like, I'm trying to understand deeply your problem, so I find what's a good fit for you.

[01:06:18 - 01:07:05]
And sometimes it's saying like, you're not a good customer. Sometimes it's saying like, actually you're not a good fit, we don't sell that problem at all. Like, I tend to be like, here's some other companies that make a good fit. If you're trying to do more of this, we can help you, right? Not . But so there is definitely a human component to it that you lose if you just react . Yeah. Do you have a question? I was just going to respond to whether that might work for the support, meaning that we want to try to have an agent to ask this. I really want to show the product, but answering Yeah, you can try to do it. If they can tell, say, I would be like, no, just show me the product.

[01:07:06 - 01:07:53]
No, I'm not. But if it's a person and they're like, could you just let me know what you think about this and ask it in a nice way? As a person, I am way more likely to answer it because I won't just be like, you know, when you're on the phone and say anything, no, no, no, I'm going to talk to someone. Right? Dude, that's an amazing handle. I mean, it's a demo itself, like, so you can just shift immediately. Like, if there's a human answer, we can go. But everything goes. Yeah. Yeah. Do it. Here are the things that an excuse can answer, right? You just lose part of the, if you are trying to understand, like, if they're doing, like, buy versus build, if they're, like, the main stakeholder, right? Because you are probably not going to ask, are you the main decision maker? because nine times out of ten they're going to tell you yes even if they're not.

[01:07:53 - 01:08:40]
And you're like, oh, okay, absolutely. Like, what does the process look like when you buy things like this? Does it go to someone else internally? Because it usually does go to someone else internally. It's usually not just done buying it, but they're going to tell you that they do it. Right? Maybe I'll go back to it. But yeah, I'm the decision maker. They're not going to be like, but are you really? Like. That's how you frame this. Yes. Yeah. Yeah. How will you decide to move on? I don't know. Right? Yeah. Yeah. And then try with the person and compare and see what works and what works for different industries or markets. Because maybe for fintech product it doesn't work if they ask more things, but maybe for just another beauty marketing product it does. When you decide to fire the customer in the process.

[01:08:41 - 01:09:28]
like sometimes when we go through schools, it's like, like one of the times it's okay, fine, we're not going to move forward so we can't work together. Well, I wouldn't say it like that. How would you do that? Yes, how would you do that? It's kind of a random process, right? If you're like on the discoverer call with them and you're like, we literally cannot do the thing you want us to do, right? If you're like, we do AI agents and you want like someone to like paint your holes in your We're not a person. We can't do this for you. Then you let them know them. You don't do it general because you're literally not trying to solve the problem that we solve our problem. And then later, let's say they come

back and do all the more things and they're giving the best prize and then they're in a bad position. It's not a good customer. You should not put your own bad position, but whenever you give people something, you

[01:09:28 - 01:09:59]
should always get something in return. Sometimes it's like, oh, can you put this together, this custom demo for me? Can you just actually do this one thing? We would actually do this We'll buy tomorrow if you build this part, but we really need that part to do it. Right? You should never do things if they just ask for them. Right? If they ask for it, you ask for something back. We can absolutely build that. We need a six month commitment. Oh, Engage are working with us. We'll build it. It'll take us a month. Right? Or if they're like, oh, can you send us over a proposal? Can you send us a debt? How are you doing all those things? Right? And you're like,

01:10:00 - 01:20:00

[01:10:00 - 01:10:44]
oh, yeah, absolutely. But let me ask you a question first. Usually when people ask that, they have some more questions around x, y, z. Or usually we bring these other people on board to answer some questions when we do a group strategy session. That's usually what other customers like to do. We could do this, but usually what people do is this other thing. Can we do this other thing? Yeah. Right? It's reframing. You're just reframing the conversation right? Especially very, very early. A lot of times the customer manages you, right? They're like, oh, sorry, I missed the call. Oh, sorry. I missed this one too. Can we actually go on next week on Monday? Can we go on Monday? Stop. Right? It's just yanking me around. And they're like, can you build these other things? If you build these other things, then we'll definitely sell it.

[01:10:45 - 01:11:30]
Right? Now, they're going to ask for the move, right? Because they're moving, especially if you say yes. People say yes, they're like, cool, what else can I ask for? Right? If you're going to build it for me, fantastic. right but you ask for things back right how can we do another demo call here's what I would like to have on the call to be able to do it so it makes sense for all of us right yeah okay aligning the buying process and selling process this is important not just for you but for all of your new hires right for anyone that you hire whether they're sales people customer success people right because they are often doing themselves you want to be thinking about how you're how you're thinking about them and how you're talking internally about what that looks like, right? So, whether you're documenting it, whether you're drawing it out, right?

[01:11:30 - 01:12:14]
Whether you say here are stages, here's what it looks like to sell to a government with Asta, here's what it looks like to sell the whole business with Asta, right? Like, those are very different when we bring people on board. Everyone should know and everyone internally should know and understand, right? Because they're building for those customers. Even the engineers, right, should understand what the buying process looks like for customers If they don't know and they don't understand, right, they're making judgment calls, they're making decisions that are affecting customers, but you're not communicating with them on what that looks like, right, and what it should be. Yeah? What else makes sales difficult, besides all of the things we just talked about? What else makes sales hard? Besides knowing the stakeholders, knowing internally what's happening, knowing they're buying and selling classes?

[01:12:17 - 01:13:04]
How long? Maybe that's a look. How long? Maybe this is a different question. So I'm really trying to understand how I best understand their pain points. Because I think it's a little different to the space where we are. And we see . We have joined by their employers. But I'm just trying to thus evaluate the pain so I can really understand what it's like. So we're doing discovery calls. And so I think that will help with like, I'll have a list of questions. And I think choosing what some of them to understand will be more helpful. And then also the discovery questions to see where they are to see if they even know they have a problem that they won't solve. Right? Like where they're in the market. Because I think that'll determine a lot for you of like if they don't feel like they have a problem, you can't help them.

[01:13:05 - 01:13:49]
Right? Or you have to do a lot of work whether it's like webinars and content and education around like here's why the insurance space needs to do more with like wearables for all of the properties. What I'm going to say here is technology adoption. That is really hard, right? Let's see, how long did it take, right? This is showing you like different things like the telephone, washing machine, air conditioning, even a personal computer. How many years it took to reach 60% of US households? It took 29 years for a laptop to reach 60%. That's crazy, right?

[01:13:50 - 01:14:35]
That's a long time. And so when you're thinking about who's adopting technology, who's adopting things, right? About who in this space, especially with like corporates and governments are much slower. They're much slower to adopt. They're much more nervous to adopt things. Versus if you're selling to a server who's like, yeah, I tried all the things. I'm going to have to stay forever, but I'll try them all and see what happens. Right? And so when we're thinking about who they are and where they are, you're thinking about Like the ICPs that you're thinking about, the personas that you're thinking about, where do they fall in technology adoption? Right? Where are they? Are they very excited like I have to try this first. I want to be ahead of everyone else. I want to know more than everyone else in the market does

that try all the things. Are they visionaries? Are they more like, oh, this is really cool. They talk about it.

[01:14:35 - 01:15:25]
They're some of the first people to use something. They're like sharing with their colleagues. They're maybe going on webinars or on podcasts. They're talking about new things they're using. Are they pregnant? Are they saying like why should I start using this? Are you talking to some companies, some industries that are like why is this valuable for you? Tell me why this is important. They're not the I'm really excited not me saying no I'm traveling and stuff. They're like I need to understand why. I need some social proof. I need to know and understand what value this brings to me. I need to see other people using it successfully. I need to see some outcomes. Some conservative people are later. They're like I should have done this sooner but I'm just going to wait. I'm not excited. That's definitely where a lot of like government and enterprises fall, right? Teams within enterprises might fall more right on the visionary and busy side, right?

[01:15:25 - 01:16:10]
And you'll have teams that if you can get in and start working with them and then you can expand across the board, that's much better. Or as a whole are more conservative, right? So we're thinking about like the types of conversations you're having with customers, the things that they're saying, the ICPs you're testing out, the markets you're testing out. new IPB, when you're trying to market, see who you're talking to, the kind of response you're getting, right? Are they excited about trying new things? Are they trying lots of other things? Or are they like, oh, can I see a bunch of case studies? Do you have my exact industry case study? Do you have someone that I can talk to as a reference? Do you have all these other things, right? And you're like, okay, you need a lot more social proof, which is okay, but that's going to be a much longer sales cycle for you, right? Because they're not as excited to go start eating something. Yeah.

[01:16:11 - 01:16:56]
Okay. We're thinking about, who's heard the term beachhead market before? Okay, I was like, someone has to. Okay, you guys. Okay, so we're thinking about, right, this like adoption curve of where people are, and this like, right, your early ones are your like smaller markets, like the people that are like excited about technology, willing to try new things, that's usually your very first customer, right? And then when we're trying to go over to this bigger group, right, this bigger section of our, majority, people that are excited, we're thinking about, we're crossing the chasm to the majority of people, and our beachhead market, we're thinking about what do all these people have in common, right? How can we get our first access point into this larger market, and how do they align, right? And so we're thinking about this market, right? We're thinking about

[01:16:56 - 01:17:42]
how are they similar, right? How are they aligned? They buy products the same way, right? They either buy them, right? They like see people on podcasts, they go to the same conferences, They go to the same things, right? If you talk to a VP of marketing at any company in SF, they have all tried all the same products, right? Because they talk about them to each other all the time. No one will stay left behind. Everyone has the same FQLS, QO goals, right? That they're trying to hit. They all are very, very, very front and forward of like finding new technology. So the word of mouth communication is really important in a VTN market, right? People who reference you to other people, right? If it's a market in a space where people are very competitive and they don't talk to other people and don't share things, that's on a mutual market, right? You want a market where people are sharing and talking to each other and being engaged with each other, right?

[01:17:42 - 01:18:30]
You want them to have a budget that exists, right? If you are going somewhere and they have to get a budget from somewhere else, they don't have a budget, right? Like, let's say you're selling to an engineering team, like, they have budget rituals, right? It is there. It is accessing budget. If you're selling to someone like a partnerships team their budget set of like very specific things that are going to you, to events, to different things, and they have to create a budget for you, that's much harder. And you have to pull a budget from somewhere, get budget from somewhere else. That's a much harder sale than like, we have this budget to apply to a bunch of things and just deciding where to put it. So your B2M market is like they have a budget to solve a bunch of problems, and you are taking from that budget. Not like, we need to find out where in the company

[01:18:30 - 01:19:15]
we could potentially pull this budget from. compelling need right they have a problem they have a problem that you can solve it's not a nice to have it's not a oh this could be helpful maybe it's a we have this problem and we want to

solve it right that's what we're looking for in a reach the market limited competition direct access direct access meaning um there are people that you can connect with in some way right let's say you are selling to china and you're like okay you're not on linkedin you're not on places it's harder for us to access like where can you access them can you access them If you can't access them, if they're an older industry, they're not on LinkedIn, they don't have phone numbers, they don't have anything else, that's not your beachhead market. That can be a market you go after, but that's not your beachhead market because you can't access them.

[01:19:16 - 01:19:59]
You don't find them places, you can't see them, you can't target them in any way. They're like maybe a market that you can maybe come across in some way, but not your beachhead market to the larger group. Yes, fast decision making, right? Three month cycle max, because it's not your beach and market if you can't access and get them and expand them, right? That's one of our beach head market. Willing to try new solutions and clear success metrics so you can show ROI, right? It's very, very hard to go after a beach and market if you can't show results, right? Because they talk to each other, they talk about things that are different, that have changed, what the results look like. You have to have results and you have to be able to show them. So you say, someone just like you, you did this thing, here's the results they got from it. Right? You have to be able to do that for a vision worker.

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Yes? Questions about that? Yeah? I would say for those early golfers and innovators, for that means the sales cost even shorter. So they make the fastest decisions. Yeah, so they're willing to try more things. They might not stay forever, but they're willing to try more things. For example, for us, they're getting the fastest pilots, the fastest distribution. Yeah, it would be people that are willing to do your things. Those are the people that are willing to do your things. So, yeah, yeah, like innovation department, you have budget to try to throw out things, right? Because they're like, that's their job. Innovation departments? That's like innovation departments? Yep. They have certain budgets? Yep. Just for testing and trying things, right? And then the budget will go to someone else, whoever owns it, whatever area you're fixing,

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but their budget is specifically to try these things, especially enterprises, right? They often have an innovation team. Now there's also AI teams that are pitched a thousand times a day.

[01:21:05 - 01:21:53]
So, you were doing personas with Justina a little bit and I want to just talk about the difference between one ICP is and a persona and what I want you to think about when you're talking about ICPs and markets that you're going after. So, your persona helps you target between different types of people. What they like, what they do in the morning, all of those things, and you know all of them. Your ICP is much more structural. I want you thinking about your industry demographic. I want you thinking about geography. I want you thinking about the size of the company, the salary of the person, the need in the pain point that they have, any decision-making factors, the way that they consume media, the way they access things, and any custom data points. And custom data points are things that will tell you something about the company, like

[01:21:53 - 01:22:40]
is a proxy for a company. So when we're thinking about what our ICP is, right? When we're thinking about specific verticals in industry, the company size, I want you to be so specific. Is it 50 to 500 employees? Is it the amount of error that they're at? Is it the employee count? We're thinking about geography. Is it like large cities in North America? Is it cities over a million people in Europe? I want you thinking about how targeted can you be for where customers are and where you're looking for them. It could be tools they already use. If you're like, hey, if you already use Slack, you could use our tool. If you already use an applicant tracking system, then you could use our website for finding managers.

[01:22:40 - 01:23:27]
If you're already spending money on something, it's easier. If they're not spending money, if they don't have a contracting system, if they're not already investing in recruiting, it's much harder to get a budget than it is for someone who's shown that they already are willing to spend a million on it. So when you're thinking about what that looks like, are there any proxies? Are there any things that would show you, okay, they're already spending money in this area, right? And so we can use that because you'll be a better customer for us because I can kind of already know you will have a budget because you have a budget. Yeah. I'm thinking about like the use case and how they're using it. Right. And so your ICP might have the use case of here's why they're going to use this for us. Right. Of here's what they care about. Here's what we're going to solve for them. It might be buying behavior, how they make purchase decisions. And it might be like their budget, like how much they'll spend.

[01:23:28 - 01:24:16]
Right. Because if you know other softwares that they bought, we know how much money they send on software. Right. Most softwares you can see how much people are spending and how much they cost. So if you have Salesforce, you are already spending a lot of money, right? How many employees that you have, right? And are you paying? So it's a thousand dollars a year, right, for employees. So you're already spending, I already have an approximate amount, I know how much you're spending, right? To give you like some anchor, like some context or price. So we're thinking about ICPs, right? Let's say I'm selling an applicant tracking system and I want to sell to finance. Finance companies in major cities, I want to go after San Francisco, Chicago, New York, I'm looking after are VP, people, head of people, head of HR, and the custom data I care about

[01:24:16 - 01:25:02]
is the last sort of review rating because if they have, do you know what the last sort is? Okay. It's like an employee review company, so I can give them a rating. And so if you have a higher rating, the employers are happier there, right? And so I'm like, I think if people invest more and people are happier at companies, then they're going to spend more on their recruiting and on the people side of things because they've shown that they care and do more for their employees. And that would be like an ICP that you would say, this is what I'm going to test because I think this is a proxy for me that they will send on this and that they care about this. If they have a low GLAPSOR score, that means they don't care about it, so they're not putting money into recruiting or into the people side of things because they don't really care. Where can we get the information that they use these kind of specific tools?

[01:25:03 - 01:25:53]
So, Glassdoor is just publicly available so you can just look. It's just like a website. Yeah, it's a website. But you still play Buildit? Buildit? No, we don't have to play. We use Play. Play has a . Yeah. On your case, you just use the . Okay, I mean, you can use anything, right? Some people will use like either through play or play is expensive so sometimes people just use it with and pull from there and say like I want all people that are using like leather like an African tracking system I want everyone doing that because I think people that pay for this will pay for something else so you can do something like that right to find some of those it could be something like there's a solar company that like wanted the square footage of buildings because

[01:25:53 - 01:26:42]
Because they're like, you have to be between a certain size of a rooftop for us to put some of them there. So we have to find that. And you can find it, right? You can go get it. But it's just like a custom data point. And like, why would we waste time talking to people who are either like too big or like too small and don't fit, right? So when you're thinking about your ICP and your customers and what they care about and what they're spending and the problems that they're solving for the size that they're at, what are some custom things that would be relevant for you that you could try, right? It might be you try a couple ICPs or you interview and ask some of your customers some more things to find out things that they have in common. Like you might find out that everyone uses some random marketing tool. And you're like, oh, okay, so everyone who uses this newer marketing tool would also use us because they're like buying a bunch of new things to be innovated in the market.

[01:26:42 - 01:27:27]
Right? But you're like, okay, then they'll buy us too because they're a good fit, right? Because they're trying and testing different things. But like you guys know your markets best, right? So here are some customers we have in common. We can think about the things that they have that might be some custom data points that might be some specific ICPs. But being very, very specific on your ICP and trying to find some proxies, right, or information that is more than just this company size, this location, this place, right? Because your messaging is not going to be very targeted, right? If I target all of the people that are just finance, major cities, company size with this title, more that I would have, but my messaging and writing things that I'm thinking that they

[01:27:27 - 01:28:15]
care about are not going to be the same, right? I'd rather you send, and we'll talk about this tomorrow, I'd rather you send much, much fewer messages that are highly targeted and very specific and speak to the person than not send 10,000 emails, right? It means nothing to me if you're like, you sent 10,000 emails today. I do not care, right? How many of them responded to you? Okay, you automated and sent a bunch of emails, right? What does that help you do? forward and do like not very much right if you're like hey i sent 25 really really targeted emails like super specific and i got two people to respond great if you said i said 10 000 emails and two or five like that's kind of terrible right you're just gonna ruin your domain yeah um we'll talk about the more fun okay so icps here are like very specific i have three examples

[01:28:16 - 01:29:02]
that um that you guys can look at a reference um later because this is how specific i want you to I want you to be thinking about, okay, I'm looking at mid-market B2B SaaS companies in the U.S. and Canada. I want to look at companies that use sales stores. HubSpot have 10 open sales roles or SDR roles because I think that means they're hiring a lot. They're trying. They're not only hiring a lot, have budget for that, but probably also have a budget for other things if you have a lot of roles open, right? Maybe they've recently hired a VP of sales or robots leader, right? because that could be a trigger for me that when a new revenue leader comes in they have 90 days to make some impact and make some changes right for 90 days they can basically buy or do whatever they want before people start

being like what's happening with our numbers what are you doing so

[01:29:02 - 01:29:48]
they try to do as much as they can in the first nine days right so that's a really good time to target people um funding although funding is hit or miss right because if you announce that you have a funding round everyone messages you it's like now you have money you want my product so about the pain point that you're solving, right? Not just, saw you raise a series B, do you want to buy my product? No, right? These are gonna get 10 million emails like that. Um, such a two profile with like 20 plus reviews because people are reviewing them, maybe they care about that more, right? You're thinking about that. Thinking about trigger events, um, again, the hiring, new ops, appearing at conferences, right? If they're appearing at conferences like, okay, you're at least spending, you're hearing conferences, you're sponsoring them, you're spending 10 to 20k per event to the conference I know you're at least sending that option on thing right?

[01:29:49 - 01:29:59]
Yeah at least all these things seem very very credible to what you do and to be honest I tried the majority

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of those already and none of those overcome. But did you try with messaging that we went over on? Yeah, obviously I tried it related to this proxy we are talking about. So yeah, I tried to tie the message to the problem that might be associated with them hiring 10SDR for example. I mean back then, I was going to have zero results. I'm having a hard time to come up with new forms. Because these might seem very obvious to what we do. And how we do sales, tiring, SDRs, using some tools.

[01:30:46 - 01:31:35]
That's what I'm planting. We can talk more interesting. Tomorrow we'll talk about outreach. I know some of you are excellent in outreach. We'll talk about outreach tomorrow. I don't know how many you're sending. We haven't talked about that yet. Each proxy is obviously shrinking your time and you cannot send like a thousand if you have a hundred or even less that might break you. Yeah, there definitely are. So when we're thinking about our ICPs and thinking about messaging, someone before they buy needs to see you six or seven times. And so if you send two or three emails, that's basically two or three times, right?

[01:31:35 - 01:32:20]
Maybe not even two or three times, right? So tomorrow we'll talk about like a multi-channel approach because now you can't just send an email. You can't just send an email. I forgot to mention that I used LinkedIn and email. Yeah, yeah, yeah. And things, but also like right now cold calling is becoming more popular, on social media is more popular, right? connecting with people into a conference and like interacting and providing some value is very common. Like there's a lot more things to do than just like sending some emails with just messaging. You now have to be more, right? You have to offer some additional value besides just sending a message. So we'll talk about like examples tomorrow. Like one of the ones I think I mentioned to you guys from a company last batch. They bring product also.

[01:32:21 - 01:33:12]
And what they did is, this is what a lot of people would like to do, I think we talked about it already, is reaching out to people and doing an ebook for product leaders, you could do for marketing leaders, right? About like this, this, and this. We have these logos already talking to us. We'd love to talk to you as well. And that has been an excellent lead generation channel for them. Excellent. Because people want to talk to them. They're like, could you just give us a look on our product, right? And then they can bring their product and then some of them use it, half of them use it I think after these interviews. And so, do the toy course. What? The toy course. Did they try hard? Yeah, do the toy course. Oh, true course, yes. Yes, yes, yes. Yes, yes. So, right, you can do something like that, right? But there's a lot more things that you can do in providing value, right? Another company from a previous match, I have an example, there's tomorrow, they do software for airlines, right?

[01:33:14 - 01:34:03]
not great until we changed it, right? But then they offered like some data points, some data that the airlines do not have, and now all of the airlines want to talk to them, right? Because they're like, you have some interesting data that we don't have. We'd all love to talk to you, right? And everyone responds to their messages. So sometimes it's about the content, right? Sometimes it's about like how you're approaching them. Sometimes it's about reaching them in different ways. And there's a lot of things that you can do when we talk about outreach, but it's never just like we already tried and sent these to the ICPs with a message. Like there's always more things that you can try to do, right? Okay, great. But we can brainstorm more office hours also. I'm happy to talk about more proxies. So I have a bunch of examples of ICPs to just get you thinking about what proxies you could use or what you could have, right? If it's, if I'm selling to multi-location healthcare clinics, right?

[01:34:03 - 01:34:49]
They have 10 to 200 locations or 100 to 2,000 employees. I want to know how many locations they have listed. I don't know if they're private equity backed or recently acquired. If they're hiring practice managers, right? They're hiring practice managers because they need more admins, because they have more like management things that they're trying to do that they're like falling behind in. If they're expanding into new cities, If they're using a known EHR system, right, then job postings a lot of times if you're hiring a nurse, you're hiring a CD, or saying like are you familiar with the CHR that we already use because this is the one we're using. And so job postings will often give you a lot of

information about the company, right, about things that you're expected to do, things that they do internally, or things that they want you to already know, right, and so you can pull a lot of interesting information from there.

[01:34:51 - 01:35:35]
But so there's different things you could look at here, right, for healthcare. right okay we're looking at a law firm and we're looking at different practice areas we're looking at hiring for different roles legal tech or document systems that they're looking at recent partner hires mergers right because all of these anytime there's a trigger event I call the trigger event or something that happens it gives you an opportunity for change right when there's an opportunity for change there's a time that you can come in and do something different right that is a nice opening because of their new hires there's new people there's a lot of new hiring they're already pruned and ready to make some changes in the organization. Does that make sense? And then examples. And this trigger, you will be typically able to find anywhere, like signals and anything.

[01:35:36 - 01:36:21]
Yeah, yeah. And that's what would be their hiring. Hold up, even LinkedIn streaming was like they're hiring like this is what they're projected to hire because they've been hiring a lot or like their teams have been pretty flat or like sales has increased by 10% over the past quarter. So you can do things like that. So some where you can be like, I think this is maybe an interesting data point for us. Let's try and see and talk to more of them and see if it does help us or if it's not nice again. We'll try another one. OK? And those are some examples for you to look at. So good custom data points for you. I know you guys already are thinking about them. Who else is thinking about some data points? Who else is using some custom data points right now? What are you using? Not bad signals.

[01:36:22 - 01:37:07]
like number or type or? Just the fact that the particular ICP is hiring for all. It sounds like it's a role in cliche but it's just a role. Okay, great. Now in case of this is a product launch, sales growth. and some posts from ICP about the strategy of the management responsible for the first time. Oh, great. OK, perfect. What else? Anyone else? Anyone thinking about some now? That could be? Yeah, you still have some.

[01:37:08 - 01:37:52]
Yeah. It's kind of more sales process, depositions. New market. New market. New market. New market. Yeah. New market opening. New market opening. New market opening. Could be also like new bars or restaurant openings, right? And then second location or like a studio opening, like a quality studio or a bar. like if they're opening a location they also need frontline workers right like usually at least by me i always see them months in advance they're like okay there's no location here um which is also maybe an interesting interview anyone else what about yeah yeah we try both these things like uh

[01:37:54 - 01:38:43]
wordpress okay and it's dying now i'm going to be informed that the purpose is dying Everyone is using phones. What's the good about that? Our challenge really is to have a soft, B2B, all of the challenges for the B2B working role, for the industry, B2B SaaS. Is it really an industry? Because B2B SaaS solves everything. What's your feeling of that? Because I'm thinking it's like... No, you should take a sub-internative. You know what I mean? But even, right, it might be something that doesn't scale now, but something that you could think about, right? um uh when i worked with google something that they wanted that they had actual people do was they would go look at websites for their like new new business they wanted um for their cloud

[01:38:43 - 01:39:30]
uh business they wanted to look at websites and they had a specific list of things they want to see so does it look like a 90s website does it have an email that doesn't pop out does it have like these specific colors like they're like this is our target ic key of who we want to get and we want to pay someone to go through to identify because this is exactly if they have a website like this this is exactly our target and we're going to do this what people would want so like what are things that you will learn about your customers or maybe you could ask or find out about that is like very random not scalable thing but for right now you can definitely do it right to identify and find out like you are a good customer and it's this very random thing like that you have like maybe they have like a contact us instead of um like booking directly at an counter. Maybe it's like a very random thing that you're like, this makes no sense, but

[01:39:30 - 01:39:59]
everyone that has this thing actually thinks we're great for them. So we're going to find more of them like this, right? Things that don't make sense, that are not just like your typical job listings or things that are opening. Like what else

do your customers have in common? Your best customers, the customers you have now, what do they have in common? What do they do? Where do they spend their time? That you can say like, okay, everyone that goes to this conference their company is our customer right maybe it's a random conversation we know another thing is um uh

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[01:40:00 - 01:40:46]
leader. So there's a thought leader in finance and whoever. And then we get the news and we let them know, hey, it's just a little bit of this. That's what we're relying on as well. Like speaking about things? Yes, all of those things. Many, many things. OK, so I want you to make a list of five to seven potential ICPs, right, with different data points. And I want you to map them. I think some of you have already talked about doing this. I want you to plot them on here with our, what access is pain level, how much of a pain do they have? Right? The problem that you're solving, how painful is this problem for them? Is it a lot? Is it the middle? Is it a little? Do you not know? You should find out if you don't know. Right? But clock, the ICP, where is it? And then ease of reach. How easy is it for you to reach them? How hard is it for you to reach them? Right? And we, as well as up to the right, those are the people that we want to go for first.

[01:40:46 - 01:41:30]
Right? The ICPs that we want to target. The people that are, have the biggest problem they want to solve and the easiest for us to access and reach. Yeah? That's true. A question. Yeah. Well, this is your pitch. Am I right that the bigger company, the harder to reach their CX level of the B's? Well, it depends on what you're doing, right? It depends on how you reach them. Generally, yes. But maybe you're like, hey, maybe you have a concern. The result is like, hey, I'm a student at this university, and I'm researching these things. So I talked to you for 15 minutes and interview you. Also depends on your region. I'm told to do this, unfortunately. Totally. Someone else. There's someone else on your team.

[01:41:32 - 01:42:22]
But it depends on your area too, right? In the Bay Area, a lot more people are willing to respond or be friendly. They're like, hey, I'm here for two weeks. Like, I would love to chat. I admire that you did an X, Y, and Z. I would love to meet. People are like pretty open to meeting. But other areas, not so much, right? People don't. So yes, generally they're harder to reach, but if it's a huge problem that they have, they may forward they email to someone else and say, hey, do you want to talk to them about this? Like, we just talked about this last week in our meeting. They might not talk to you, but they might forward it internally, right? Mm-hmm. And so in thinking about what they care about and the type of messaging you give, right? So here, also as an example, right? we'll talk about messaging again tomorrow but um when you're targeting people and talking about

[01:42:22 - 01:43:12]
the problems if you target a cro or a vp of sales at a large company and they have like 50 sales people and you say are your demos not converting they're not going to respond to you that is not their level right not at all that would not respond right but if you're talking about like hitting their targets or you do something of helping them like hit for their quarter or team's performance or you help increase something else right that like they care about everyone talks the same no everyone like about hitting the targets well i don't know but how you do it right well we're going to talk about value props in a minute or maybe about the lunch and i don't remember the ceiling but like very specifically about like the toggles that you're solving for them right and

[01:43:12 - 01:44:01]
how you solve them is really important but if you're going like too high right those people at a learner company those people do not care because your problems are very operational that you're solving right and so then you need to target and talk to the people whose job is solving the operational problems right because they care right and they want to solve it and they're going to like break it up to solve their problems right um because again if you're if your messaging is targeted towards the wrong type of person they are not going to respond it doesn't matter what your about something that they functionally don't care about or are responsible for, they're not going to respond. Yeah? um save a few icps of how are we feeling so it's 11 30. i know it's been 90 minutes you want to stand up for a second and wiggle around a little and then we'll finish a little bit and i think

[01:44:01 - 01:44:46]
we'll do more after the lunch while i'm on the floor yeah okay so shake for five minutes run to the bathroom go up like in the mirror walk back in i know 90 minutes is a long time to like sit in one place i mean i'm standing you can all stand too five minutes five minutes come back and i'll and then we'll do these. Water, peanut banana. How are you? It was good. Good. Yeah, it was perfect. Ah, really? I look at you every time. Everything. Because it's not much cheaper. Much cheaper. I need to say, here. Yeah.

[01:44:46 - 01:45:32]
Because in San Francisco it's like a double price. Oh, okay. I think you can hear it. Oh, nice. Was it okay? It was good, it was good. On Saturday, the bar just under our apartment, they had a party until 6.30 am. It's a very loud music. Really? Yeah, yeah, yeah. We are three businesses at all. Yeah. Yeah, it was really exciting for us. What street are you on? Sure. Are you on the street? Or what street are you on? You didn't get it.

[01:45:32 - 01:46:21]
Street? Yeah, it's like Park Street. They are most probably favorite food. The large food here. It's very close to this. It's very loud. I even called the A's. Really? Yeah. They called me. Nothing. It's crazy. Yeah. I went to pharmacy at like 1.30 to grab some ear implants. Did they help? Yeah, it was great. It was a great thing. Everything was great.

[01:46:21 - 01:47:06]
Yeah, it's not possible in areas. Like this kind of, you know, just living here, you can open a bar so you can play the music as long as a whole lot. I mean, it is possible. Really? Yes, there are a lot of things. You'll probably have a legal level with the city and yourself for the business. Because it has to be zoned properly. Like there was an interest that happened where it was a huge catapulting. But if it's zoned correctly, there's not really much you can do about it. There's no ways, time drop or anything.

[01:47:06 - 01:47:40]
There aren't like rural, like the top. Like there's a no idea. yeah and if it's done correctly okay you can find other dummies so like don't pick the bar because I was really sure inside this is not really yeah yeah you can go to the police up there 10pm or 11pm and yeah yeah here's one it's a problem

[01:47:52 - 01:48:37]
Here? Yeah. So I was like, I think this sounds like this one time from the door, but like, hold them, they don't want to do this, it doesn't mean I'm not going to do it. Yeah. Let me do it. Let me do it. Yeah. Thanks. So we are not friends. Yeah. And every night, every night the police comes to our street, So now you can raise a lot of time. There's a lot of music from Sunday morning. I'm quite quiet.

[01:48:38 - 01:49:23]
I'm praying to do that on the night. But there's still a lot of time going to silence. Yeah. Don't care. It's not enough like a noise. I guess I had to do this. Yeah. So maybe a little more. Yeah. Perfect. Just so I can not forget how to do a bunch of conditions. So good. Okay, guys, we're ready to come back. We just have a little bit more, and we'll do value propositions after lunch, I think. We'll just finish up the leave-in and buy-in. And then, just a couple more things to follow the list. to close the loop on this, right? Building a list, right?

[01:49:23 - 01:49:59]
Like, contacts are very cheap. You can buy a list of 5,000, 20,000, 100,000, right? You can buy a list, you can buy a list, and then you can put some contacts that are probably a little bit out of date, are not the best fit, are just like a list of chaos, right? Don't buy a chaos list, right? Lists are not for real, right? We, people who are genuinely interested, who have some sort of proxy, some sort of figure, some sort of identification that show that they would be a good fit for you, right, are the ones you want. We don't have them.

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[01:50:00 - 01:50:56]
If you're like, yay, I just downloaded the list of 100,000 people, like, I literally do not care. Are they a good fit for you? Are 200 of them a good fit for you? Then I care, right? Then I want to talk about that. So I want to make sure when you're thinking about things, when you're thinking about your metrics, your KPIs, or if you hire someone on your team, right? If you hire someone to do outreach, and they're like, I reached out to 5,000 people today. Who did you reach out to? Were they the ICP? Did they have anything, like, relevant or interesting? just reach out to 5,000 people, right? We don't want that. Quality versus quantity, right? And I just, I want you to be thinking about like the quality of the leads of the people that you have because the conversion is better, lifetime value is better, your customer acquisition accounts is better, all the things are better. In terms of some tools, this is one that people love to show. There's so many tools you can use. There's probably a thousand more every day of different things that people are building, especially with AI of like sales tools you can use, right?

[01:50:57 - 01:51:42]
um so many to use like for your initial lists right like thinking about again the proxies and where you can get um information that may be the proxy information to start for your initial ones because we want to be very targeted right we don't want to go follow and download lists of like thousands of thousands of people that is thousands are not our customers that is just random people on the internet that have an email that we can see right those are not our people so we're thinking about like built with um orange slice cognizant like we want to use a larger database to filter and think about our spds and think about specific targets that we want to go after and then we want to try to access them yes um you can also write like sometimes people will hire you can hire someone on upwork um a freelancer somewhere for like three or four dollars an hour to go through and be like

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i need you to look at like their website right like google it i need you to look at all their websites and I need you to mark whether they have like this thing or not right start to do the same things they're like we want to know they're real company these five things mean that they're real companies need something to go through and check these things right or you can build an agent a lot of you are checking them you don't have to say like yeah yeah to go through and like check someone's data right you can definitely do that as well um more places um that you can look at like webinar registrants right if you build your own lead channel with webinars or you partner with people um you can partner with someone who has a similar customer base to the world market as you not the same product right not your competitors you could but like with someone who has the same market as you and you do webinars together to start building your own lead funnel and channels so you are an expert in something in some field

[01:52:31 - 01:53:19]
you all are very chatty so i know you can definitely do it right with not that much lift to have a webinar have some sort of series where you're talking about something talking about teaching people about something to start like driving more of your traffic right um company news podcast guest lists um linkedin groups in different communities um or competitive customer stories right some people do that if you're like i know that every person that uses this competitor hates this thing i know that companies in the fintech space that use this person hate this product because of that you'd be like hey we solved this very specific problem that i know you have with a competitor because everyone has this problem but we know differently because this right Before a company goes on your list, right? Before you message them, before you do anything with them, do this in your ICP.

[01:53:19 - 01:54:12]
Do this in an ICP that you have? Is there like a pain point? Right? Do they have a problem? Do I think there's a problem? Is there a trigger event? Can I identify the right buyer? Or is it a new market and do I not know the buyer? And so I kind of need to go and figure out, I need to do interviews, I need to navigate, I need to ask someone who has a space, like who the real buyer would be. And then do I have a credible reason to reach out now? Not, saw you as series B, no. At series B, what things happen? Are they hiring a week of sales? Because usually people will write at series B, they're like, now I need sales leaders, I can go from B to C. It's a different person than from A to B. Are they like, is the CEO thinking about hiring a new person? That would be a good time for a recruiting tool, right? Because you're like, you need a very specific person to go from that stage. What other things can you reach out for that are going to help the person at the right time that are some sort of event, some sort of thing because they need to solve that problem now.

[01:54:14 - 01:55:00]
Best practices, potential customers, good content. I don't know if you guys are creating a lot of content. I think you talked about that before last week with Justina. But like relevant, interesting content that you can use for your sales as sales collateral. right because if you're not creating sales content for your sales collateral the sales people that you hire will create either and you will not like it okay it's going to be they're going to make things up they're going to put random things in the sales content that they're going to send to customers and you're going to be like what is that how did you put that there so when we're thinking about the content that we have and we'll talk about some content tomorrow um thinking about what that looks like right your goal throughout all your steps throughout the sales process is to get them to take the next out with you right if you get them on the first call you want to get on the next call you want to get the next stakeholder you want to get someone else involved you want to get a demo next you want to get

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confirmation proposal right you want a next step always every time you talk to a customer you should one learn something new and two move them on to the next step right you should never be ending any calls or conversations or anything with like great okay we're not internally and we'll follow later okay we'll follow up next week about scheduling a call no we want to do it on our call right for next steps um stakeholders i'm going to talk about okay it's 11 42 how are we feeling and with that for a while i have stakeholders and i have customer value proposition still do we want to do that after lunch or do we want to do stakeholders now because i know people are a little distracted we have some computers we have some phones poking around okay okay then

[01:55:47 - 01:56:33]
attention again everyone no both computers pay attention to your stakeholders thank you okay what is what is the stakeholder how many stakeholders what's the stakeholder some somebody on the buying process will influence the buying process full influence yep sometimes they influence sometimes they order they are an actual decision maker they're not always decision makers right but we're thinking and mapping out like how to identify what an org looks like or what the company looks like especially for enterprise or companies government any alarm right or mapping out what those looks like even smaller companies right to understand where people are where they sit what their priorities are and who owns what right or mapping out at first if you start actually writing them out and putting them

[01:56:33 - 01:57:22]
somewhere so you can see them so you can talk about it with your team because there's usually like a space where like someone is here and i don't know who that person is but they mentioned having a partner on the working side and I mentioned having someone here and needed to find out who that is right we're mapping out what they look like and we're mapping them out because there's a few different types of stakeholders um who's thought about like types of stakeholders before in this way economic technical okay great um so I want you to think of stakeholders in four buckets so our economic buyer our technical buyer our influencer and our coach and so our economic buyer is one who has a budget right they're the one who's like your final decision maker who's deciding whether they're going to buy or not um thinking about what that looks like um and making the rental decision right our technical buyer our technical buyer is the one who's looking at

[01:57:22 - 01:58:09]
does this have the features and the functionality that i needed to have does this meet can we integrate with this can we put this in our systems can we include this in a functional way that makes sense right and oftentimes founders get stuck in a technical buyer because they're often the ones that want to talk to you and they want to talk to you for a long time and they're like can you show us this how does this work can you connect with this what does this look like i'm interested in this like functionality i'm interested in this i'm interested in this they make no decisions they're just going through like if you build this other thing then where's your product but we really need these two other things to be able to move forward because it's like really important for us right and it's really easy to get stuck with them oftentimes they don't actually need that thing that they want to be built it's just remember we talked about like companies build little super

[01:58:09 - 01:58:54]
requirements or things that they think they need because a bunch of stakeholders a bunch of people have said like here's what we need here's what we're looking for right and they're going out and this technical buyer is like here's our list of things that i need to check off to make sure we have right and if you don't check off the things they dismiss you unless you understand why they And you sometimes have to bring the other stakeholder that wanted that thing back in, right? Or it's something that you can either do a proxy thing to still make it work. You could still get the value. You

can still solve the problem that they have without that feature functionality, right? But it's very, very easy to get stuck with this technical person because they'll be like, we can't use this unless you have this functionality. But you're like, well, what is your problem, right, that you're trying to solve?

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And can we solve that problem without this functionality? Can you still do some of the things? in this like maybe a manual process on our side that we can help you get your results you want and it's on our roadmap for the next six months right um so i want you to think about that when you're talking to someone like is this the person that has a budget or is this a technical person who's going to distract me and get over here and want me to do a bunch of demos and show me all the things because they want to know exactly how everything works right i think about the influencer right is someone who has an opinion who either has like some requests or things they want who might be working with it within the organization maybe they are the end user right so a lot of times your buyer is not the person that's using it maybe there's someone within the organization that has to integrate it that has to use it if they're like we use Salesforce and all the data has to go to Salesforce um maybe there's someone who just like has an opinion because they used to

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work uh in the department that you're in and they're like these are actually what we need to have and things that are right and so when you're identifying with people that you're talking to again thinking about who else might be influencing the decision and what else they might be saying and if they should be brought in right during your demo

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or during the process. And then coach. Coach is your best, best, best person. Who thinks that they've had a coach recently? Like someone within an organization. Who knows what a coach is? A champion. Yeah, like a champion. Someone who's excited. Sometimes they have nothing to do with the buying process at all. They're just like maybe more on the visionary side of like people that are early adopters and they're like, we love new tools, we love new organization no buying power not tracking them features of functionality but I'm really excited about it and I really want to help you do it right these people are so bad and helpful because they can help you about the orders they can tell you about internal priorities right because then they're nice and they want to be helpful to you if you're like I'm trying to understand like I'd

[02:00:45 - 02:01:37]
love to have you guys as a customer this quarter but like I don't understand internally like how you buy things or like where did where things get stuck who else do I need to talk to is there someone in marketing that's like in these meetings right you can ask them a lot of questions that you can't ask the other ones because they're not going to tell you right you're not going to tell you about this let me ask you a question we have one prospect is like very huge company and for example we'll be of innovation and head of the sales they are like they are our champions there but their VP of sales and VP of marketing they are quite I don't know maybe skeptical maybe they have a lot of things to do else besides like our

[02:01:38 - 02:02:27]
our thing and we don't understand how to reach them how to influence them because they are are decision makers in this process. And yeah, what can we do using these stakeholders that they're on our side? To access, do you have a coach usually, or an influencer or someone, right? And asking about priorities, because everyone has their priorities for the month or the quarter, the things that they're trying to do, right? And they're not always revenue. Like, it is always revenue, but there's always more things besides revenue, right, they're like we have some sales people that are not like in the quota so we need to like pick up for it in some way or do something else to hit my numbers because like there's just I hire someone they're not going to be able to ramp up in three months to hit the

[02:02:27 - 02:03:12]
quota that we have for the quarter right maybe it's like some other internal things where like marketing's not sending them enough MQLs which always happens it's probably always a problem where they're like MQLs are horrible like we can't convert anything right so what there are some things that they would care about, that they would be interested in, that you can ask them about, to see what they're interested in. You can ask them if they're going to be speaking at any conferences, you can ask them if they're going to be around, like if you're going in certain areas. People at the VP and C level like care about access to other people. They want to know what other people are doing, and they want to be involved in conversations, and they want to be around. So doing something with that is always something you can do because people want to be around other people that are at their home, that they don't already know or have access to.

[02:03:13 - 02:03:58]
So that's something interesting that you could like find out or do or find out like, what other conferences they go to in terms of like what other people will be there. So either you could be there, or you could like talk about something that's happening there. But you are using like the coaches, the influencers, even the checking roboters, say like, what are the priorities for the quarter? Right? Is it that like maybe they're building their own things internally, they're launching some new functionality that you can align with, right? Like when you launch this new thing, you can also have these demos So it's like understanding and turn a little bit about what their goals are. That's why we should do some work. Because there's always things happening in a company. It's never just like trying to hit our goal for the month, for the quarter. It's always like, and then these people left. And then we have this board meeting. And then we're also trying to fundraise.

[02:03:58 - 02:04:46]
And then we're also trying to hit these numbers for investors. And we're also launching this new market. There's always a lot of things happening. But aligning yourself with one of the priorities is the most important thing. But you have to know what the priorities are. they don't have this as a goal and their KPIs what should we do guys? If they

don't have goals or new guys? I mean they definitely have goals or new guys. Yeah but for example they need to generate more sales qualified leads and they have different channels for that. They can allocate their resources on like growing paid stewardship or something else. and probably what we feel like in things that all I just need to focus on my metrics

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I just need to focus on my conversions that we need to improve our marketing campaigns or something like that and probably they just don't think about our solution could help them in their... But then when you're thinking about those people right people that are not trying new things maybe not your best ICP right now. But people that are like, maybe they start a webinar series, maybe they've gone higher content writers to write more things. Maybe they're writing more thought pieces on LinkedIn. Like that would be a better customer because they're already putting money towards like solving the problem, right? That is like a trigger or a proxy for something, not just like, oh, you're just going to stay in your channel. Those are like a later adopter, right?

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Because they need to see social proof, they need to see more things, they need to do more. That's not who you should target first, right? that have something that tells you they want to try new stuff, it's really important to them, they have a problem, they're buying things to solve that problem now. That was your first customer, right? Yeah, I think that's a problem. You're like going after two later. Yeah, or you're going after two later, save your people, right? Like they're not in the process yet, they're in the like learning that we have a problem process and then learning about options, right? Yeah. And you need to go after people to like know there's a problem and are looking for people that will buy now. Do you have a question? I'll just execute the idea. Okay. Great. ICPs. Okay. So when we're thinking about stakeholders and where they go, right, we're thinking about

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putting them in buckets of like our core target group, the people that we're talking to, that our people we're targeting right away, direct stakeholders and indirect stakeholders, right, and thinking about where to put them in our group, right, we're taking them from here. So I'm saying our people here are saying Zoe is my core target group, Vanessa is for marketing. I think this is easier to read if you guys look at it on your thing. It's a little boring up here. And then our direct stakeholders are people who are still involved, right, that are either the technical, technical stakeholder, or they're an influencer or they're a coach, and then some indirect stakeholders. So like the CEO is an indirect stakeholder, right? Probably not ever going to talk to them at a larger company, right? But like they care about what's happening, right? They care about the P&L, they care about all the department's budgets,

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they care about the results that people are getting. They do care, right? And see the results and changes from the same with like an SDR, right? An SDR is also not going to be the direct person I'm selling to, but they are impacted by selling the marketing software. Like they're impacted by the number of M2Ls and then by next S2Ls that they bring into the company, right? So I want you thinking about where people fall, where these stakeholders are, and how you're interacting with them, and how you're building content or value propositions for them. Because often, with your stakeholders, when it goes up for approval for someone else, depending on the size of the company, or if it goes down, the same way if you sell high, and someone's like, great, we're not going to use this tool. Say I bought a sales tool, and people are like, I'm absolutely not using that.

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Cool, you bought it. Not going to use it. this is a hard process for us because we're really excited and the person who's the economic buyer was really excited but now this is the people who are used to use it because it's actually really hard for them to put their work through and they don't want to do it. Right? And then you're like, well this, I should have been thinking about them also. Thinking about like their honor, thinking about how they would use it as an end user because they are a stakeholder too. Because if you sell something and your end users don't want to use it, that's going to be a really big uphill battle for you. Right? Okay. Where do stakeholders fit in the buying process? Every customer that you're going to talk to is going to push the stakeholders that you want to talk to, like the BPs or CROs, people that are on fire. They want to push them to the end, right? Because they want to do all of the research. They want to find all the things. They want to bring proposals. They want to say, here's the thing, right?

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But you want to talk to them really early. You're like, we want them early. I want to talk to them on discovery call because I want to ask them all the questions. I want to align with your priorities because I don't want to try to fight you

later. And so that's going to be something that you should think about in terms of how can you get them to bring them on earlier. Like an example when I was talking earlier, if someone was like, no, I'm the decision maker. It's just going to decide and you ask more about how things are usually first internally, what the process looks like. And you learn that it's more people that are involved or someone else is going to send off on it. And say, next step, what we usually do, for people like you that are solving this problem, is our next step, we invite X, Y, and Z, these other stakeholders on the call. We go through things. We have a starting session. It's about 30 minutes.

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Who would you like to invite on this phone? Or we'd love to have this VP, this person on the call. It's usually who we have. And you frame it as, this is what normal people do. This is what usually happens. Could you bring them to the call? It would be really nice if you could bring them to the call and we'd really like to talk to them. No, they're not saying they tell you now. Right? But when you frame it as like a social norm, right? And think that like next step, this is what we do. Then it's more weird if they're like, well, we don't want to do that. And you're like, oh, like usually in the process that we do, here's how we help, right? Here's how we align with things. If you're not comfortable doing that yet,

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what would make you comfortable? Why do I want to invite you to the phone? Right? But being more direct and asking. It's totally fine to do, but it's just also being comfortable pushing back and asking those things. Yes? Okay. Problems and pain points. These we're going to do after lunch. So you guys did great. Thanks for sitting here two hours. I know that's a long time. Some days, that was probably going to be done. So grab your food and we will be cooking in the petro session on the camera. So food is already served.